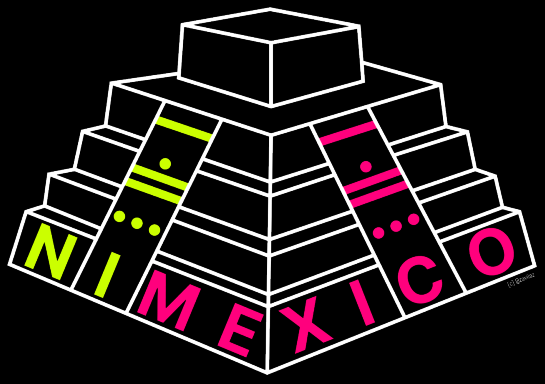


Thursday, June 1, 20:00

CONCERT 3

Shard Speakers: Beyond Hexagons

by Anastasia Clarke

Transcontinental Grapevine

by Ivica Ico Bukvic

Pandemonium Quintet play Drone & Drama Versions

by Miguel Ortiz, Barry Cullen, Anna Weisling, Rachel Austin and Paul Stapleton

Dream Structures

by Daniel Jones

Program Notes (Concert 3)

Shard Speakers: Beyond Hexagons

by Anastasia Clarke

If crystal bowls could speak, what would they say? ***Beyond Hexagons*** is a performance using the shard-speakers, a musical instrument and playback system created from the shards of broken crystal singing bowls with affixed transducers and resonators. Tracing their lifespans from quartz mines to factories and from scientific laboratories and sound studios, the bowls transmit their origin stories of purpose, function, and pleasure through a unique and alien sonic language that makes heavy use of improvisation, whimsy, and custom software instruments. The result is a sonic exploration of the paradoxes contained in these materials — strength and fragility, acuity and intuition, secrecy and frankness.

Transcontinental Grapevine

by Ivica Ico Bukvic

Transcontinental Grapevine is a new crowdsourced telematic work by the Virginia Tech Linux Laptop Orchestra (L2Ork) that was co-created and performed with collaborators from UNTREF, Buenos Aires, Argentina. The work is inspired by the introductory loop of the "Grapevine" song by Lane 8 and Elderbrook and utilizes L2Ork Tweeter online collaborative musicking platform that allows for perfect sync among performers regardless the distance (in this case two groups of performers, 11 in total, were over 5,000 miles apart). The work's EDM aesthetics intentionally seeks to test the limits of the newfound platform's ability to sync players, as well as to expand the telematic musical vocabulary. Every aspect of this work was co-created and realized collaboratively by contributors from two geographically distant areas. Virginia Tech L2Ork co-creators consist of Ivica Ico Bukvic, Justin Kerobo, Daniel Manesh, William Rhodes, Jacob Alan Smith, and Caden Vandervort. UNTREF L2Ork community co-creators include Uma Futoransky, Gala Lucía González, Joaquin Montecino, and Lauti Sosa. The work starts with Lane 8's "Grapevine" intro, and then crossfades into a crowdsourced theme and variations.

Pandemonium Quintet play Drone & Drama Versions

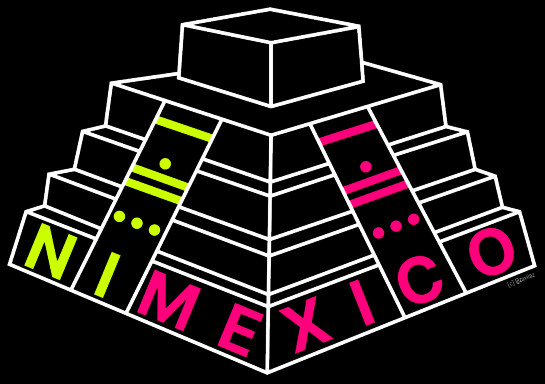
by Miguel Ortiz, Barry Cullen, Anna Weisling,
Rachel Austin and Paul Stapleton

Pandemonium Quintet play DIY electronic musical instruments (EMI). The group consists of five highly experienced music improvisers, visual artists and instrument makers dedicated to bringing audiences the finest in folktronic audio and cybernetic signals, vibrating together in heart-warming 12V ballads, oscillating between the sacred and the profane. Our current performance system is a synthesis of bespoke video and previously existing musical circuits that have been modified to promote productive instability within a restricted set of timbral possibilities. The aesthetic of our performance is informed by noise and free improvised musics.

Dream Structures

by Daniel Jones

Dream Structures is a live coding performance that uses computational audio analysis and machine learning to navigate and resample a half-terabyte archive of 90s/00s trance music, creating a live musical collage using fragments of audio from thousands of tracks. The system mines this archive for sounds of certain categories iconic to early trance and rave — animal noises, sirens, heartbeats — and uses them to generate ambient textural and rhythmic sequences, using generative patterns that are modulated on-the-fly. This is augmented by arpeggiated layers and pads using software emulations of iconic digital synthesizers including the Roland JP-8000 Super Saw, Akai MPC timestretch, and DX7 FM synth. Dream Structures is performed with SignalFlow, a free and open-source Python library for sound synthesis.



Thursday, June 1, 21:00

CONCERT 4

Sculpture DAXR

by D. Andrew Stewart

Carbon Based EM Fields

by Sofya Yuditskaya, Jess Rowland
and Margaret Schedel

Displacements

by Adriano Claro Monteiro

Where is that Batallón de San Patricio Groove?

by -ence (Paul Stapleton and Ricki O'Rawe)

Branch

by Daniel Manesh

Program Notes (Concert 4)

Sculpture DAXR

by D. Andrew Stewart

The performance of ***Sculpture DAXR*** is an offshoot of the Oscuterium project, created by the group, RedSpills, a collaborative trio of new musical instrument technologists, artists and performers: Michał Seta (Montreal, Quebec, Canada), Dirk Stromberg (Republic of Singapore), and D. Andrew Stewart (Lethbridge, Alberta, Canada). While ***Sculpture DAXR*** can be experienced as a live, in-person, multi-media show involving the karlax digital musical instrument (DMI), live coding, video and sound projection, this work is best experienced in its original form: a hybrid performance and experience in which the participants (performer, audience) inhabit both a live venue in real life (IRL) and a 3D virtual reality (VR) meeting point in Mozilla's real-time communications platform, Hubs. The innovative nature of this work arises from the production of sound directly within the Hubs environment using the Faust (Functional Audio Stream) programming language (i.e., browser-based software synthesis engine). Both sound creation and 3D objects are transformed by real-time data transmitted from a DMI over the internet.

If you want to be a member of the VR audience, open Firefox (1st choice), or Google Chrome (2nd choice), and go to the satlit link below. Navigate with WASM.

https://satlit.sat.qc.ca/vaPzWFR/2022-01-20-redspills

Avatar + webcam selection:

In the bottom righthand corner, go to More > Change Name & Avatar. Click on Change Avatar. Go to Newest > SAT_logo02. Confirm ("Accept") your changes. Activate webcam (bottom menu bar). If menu bar unavailable, or Twitch feed reads "Stream Offline", refresh browser window.

Carbon Based EM Fields

by Sofya Yuditskaya, Jess Rowland
and Margaret Schedel

EM KVLT is composed of three womxn Jess Rowland, Meg Schedel, Sofya Yuditskaya and guests who use the physical properties of the electromagnetic spectrum to create installations, performances and recordings. Using electronic feedback, audio speakers, various kinds of microphones/ pickups, and resonant objects of all shapes and kinds, we summon the feminine spirit of electromagnetism, aka the Goddess of the Electronic Medium aka the ElectroMagnetic Goddess. We have a flexible membership inclusive to all peoples who are willing to open themselves up to this spirit. In terms of current trends in audio technology, we invoke a feminist response to the masculinization of the music industry, audio engineering, and to the artistic spaces of sound arts in general.

Displacements

by Adriano Claro Monteiro

Displacements is a music and video performance that thematizes the recording of walks public spaces (a popular video genre on streaming platforms). In a space built to organize human displacements, a moving observer registers passing bodies: their directions, flows and speeds superimposed on the shades and forms of the environment are the visual information that feed an algorithmic composition based on displacements of time, space and colors. The music, likewise algorithmic and mostly synthetic, modulates the scene's meaning by providing an ethereal atmosphere uncorrelated with the expected soundscape. Having first been taken to the location and time of the movie scene, the audience is then dragged into a space of abstract sounds and images.

Where is that Batallón de San Patricio Groove?

by -ence (Paul Stapleton and Ricki O'Rawe)

Our duo *-ence* improvises live remixes of augmented 7" vinyl records combined with performance on, and sequenced sampling of, custom-made elecroacoustic instruments. Our collaboration draws on O'Rawe's experience in art installation contexts and with electronic dance music group *Not Squares*, and Stapleton's work as an instrument inventor, sound designer and improviser in groups such as Ens Ekt and 3BP. Our performance for NIME 2023 begins by asking, what kind of strange rhythmic futures will continue to be built at the intersection of Mexican and Irish cultures? To aid this endeavour, we invoke the mythology of *Batallón de San Patricio*, a group of disenfranchised European (largely Irish) immigrants and African slaves who defected from the United States Army to fight on the side of the Mexican Army during the Mexican-American War of 1846-48. The battalion has been memorialised by a broad range of musicians, novelists and filmmakers. These accounts provide stories of cultural resonances in the lives of diverse peoples, unlikely collectives who formed allegiances through their shared oppression at the hands of dominant imperialist powers. Our storytelling here is similar, but also different. While we are interested in resonances, allegiances, and points of connection that form moments of tense but productive co-existences between different communities, we are likewise drawn towards the precarious, noisy and uncertain material processes enacted in such meetings. Thus, we seek a kind of dissensual groove, an oscillation between distance and relation, remixing fragments from Irish and Mexican music traditions into fragile and ever-collapsing rhythmic architectures, creating spaces in which to move.

Branch

by Daniel Manesh

Branch is a live coding étude centered around speech and form. The piece uses the TidalCycles language alongside a tool we developed called SHARP, which provides an interactive, tree-like structure embedded in the text editor to track how blocks of code evolve over time. SHARP opens up new musical affordances centered around quickly switching between previous program states. In addition, SHARP's version trees act as a kind of post-hoc score, leaving a visual trace of the piece's structure as it unfolds. With *Branch*, we attempt to go beyond a simple demonstration of SHARP as a tool and instead create a piece which highlights the interplay between musical form, its visual representation in SHARP, and the sonic material itself. To that end, *Branch* makes use of machine-generated speech based mostly on snippets from the text of Robert Frost's poem "The Road Not Taken". The text is largely decontextualized, and its treatment is somewhat tongue-in-cheek: while the poem's premise centers around not being able to take both paths, we can easily explore as many code paths as we wish. In addition to speech, *Branch* uses audio samples from Freesound, including the sounds of twigs snapping, knocking on wood, and a person stepping on leaves.